

THE SOCIAL NAVIGATION SYSTEM™

Conversation Scripts & Friendship Frameworks

Decoding the hidden rules of connection, conflict, and community.

- **The Entry:** Moving from Parallel Play to Connection
- **The Repair:** Navigating Conflict without Meltdowns
- **The Lens:** Reading the Room & Perspective Taking
- **The Manual:** The Unwritten Rules of Social Safety
- **The Screen:** Navigating Group Chats & Digital Tones

A Complete 5-Module Curriculum (Ages 8-12)

Welcome to the System

The Social World has a Hidden Code

If you are reading this, you likely love a child who finds the social world baffling. They might be brilliant at coding, legos, or dinosaurs, but the playground feels like a foreign country where everyone else speaks a language they were never taught.

We Don't Need 'Normal,' We Need Skills

The goal of this system is not to make your child 'normal.' The goal is to make them **fluent**. Social skills are not a personality trait; they are a mechanics issue.

The Philosophy: We believe that neurodivergent social styles are valid. We are simply giving them a 'Universal Adapter' so they can plug into the rest of the world when they choose to.

How to Be the Social Coach

You are no longer just a parent; you are the Head Coach. Your job is to review the 'Game Tape' and practice drills.

1. Curiosity Over Criticism

When they make an error, don't say 'That was rude.' Ask: 'I noticed her face changed. What do you think she was feeling?'

2. The 'Hidden Rules' are Real

Explain the FUNCTION. 'Asking how are you is like a handshake. It signals safety.'

3. Practice in Low-Stakes Environments

Do not teach a new skill at a birthday party (The Super Bowl). Practice at the dinner table.

MODULE 1: THE ENTRY

Friendship Building & Joining In

Tool 01: The 'Watch, Wait, Enter' Framework

Emotional Purpose: For the child who hovers on the edge or barges in disrupting the game.

The Protocol: Social groups are like moving traffic. You must merge.

1. WATCH: Stop at the edge. 'What is the game?'
2. WAIT: Nod head to match energy.
3. ENTER: Use a Role Script.

"Cool! Can I be the zombie?"

POCKET GUIDE: Watch, Wait, Enter

Step 1: SCAN

- ☐ What are they playing?
- ☐ Is it high energy or low energy?

Step 2: HOVER

- ☐ Stand close enough to be seen.
- ☐ Wait for a pause.

Step 3: MERGE

- ☐ Helper Script: 'Need more ammo?'
- ☐ Role Script: 'Can I be the bad guy?'

Tool 02: The Conversation Ping-Pong Coach

Emotional Purpose: For the child who turns conversations into monologues.

The Concept: A conversation is not a lecture; it is Ping-Pong.

SERVE: Someone asks a question.

RETURN: You answer AND hit it back.

"That's cool. What about you?"

SCORECARD: Conversation Ping-Pong

Track your rallies here.

TURN	DID YOU HIT IT BACK?
1	[] Answer + Question
2	[] Answer + Question
3	[] Answer + Question

Tool 03: The Low-Stakes Invite

Best Used When: Your child is terrified of rejection and won't ask anyone to hang out.

The Strategy: Lower the pressure. Don't ask for a 'Playdate'. Ask for company.

The High-Stakes Script (Avoid):

"Will you play with me?" (This feels big and scary).

The Low-Stakes Script (Use):

"I'm going to the park. Want to come?" (This is casual).

The 'Cool' Reaction to No:

"No worries, maybe next time!"

MODULE 2: THE REPAIR

Conflict Resolution & Resilience

Tool 04: The 'Game Tape' Review

The Psychology: Uses Objective Analysis. By acting as a 'Sportscaster', we remove shame.

"Okay, timeout. Let's look at the Game Tape. Rewind to 2:00 PM. Everything was fine. Let's see what happened."

WORKSHEET: The Conflict Autopsy

PHASE 1: THE CALM

What were we playing? _____

PHASE 2: THE TRIGGER

I wanted: _____

They wanted: _____

GLITCH: Different Goals!

PHASE 3: THE REPAIR

Next time I can: _____

Tool 05: The 'Grey Rock' Method

Emotional Purpose: For the child who is easily baited by bullies.

The Psychology: Bullies feed on dopamine (reaction). Be boring.

"Okay." ... "Maybe." ... "Are you done?"

Tool 06: The Impact vs. Intent Apology

Best Used When: Your child refuses to apologize because 'It was an accident!'

The Concept:

Intent: What you meant to do. (I didn't mean to step on your foot).

Impact: What actually happened. (My foot hurts).

The Script:

"I didn't MEAN to hurt you, but I see that I DID. I am sorry for the impact."

MODULE 3: THE LENS

Reading the Room & Perspective Taking

Tool 07: The 'Traffic Light' Monologue Checker

Green Light: Eye contact, smiling. (Keep going).

Yellow Light: Looking away. (Wrap it up).

Red Light: Sighing, checking phone. (Stop).

DASHBOARD: The Listener's Face

CHECK THE LIGHTS:

- ☐ Green (Safe)
- ☐ Yellow (Caution)
- ☐ Red (Stop)

EMERGENCY BRAKE:

If you see Red, ask: 'Anyway, how was your day?'

Tool 08: The Sarcasm Detector

Best Used When: Your child takes 'Great job!' literally when they spilled milk.

The Clue: Tone Mismatch

If the Words are NICE, but the Voice is FLAT or MEAN... that is Sarcasm.

Examples:

1. 'Wow, you're a genius.' (Said after dropping a plate).
2. 'Oh, I loooove homework.' (Said with an eye roll).

MODULE 4: THE MANUAL

The Hidden Rules of Society

Tool 09: The Protection Filter

The Concept: Imagine everyone has a heart of glass. Honesty is a hammer. We need to filter the hammer so it doesn't break the glass.

Script: *'Thank you for thinking of me!' (Even if you hate the gift).*

Tool 10: The Code Switching Explainer

Best Used When: Your child talks to the principal the same way they talk to their gaming buddies.

The Metaphor: Clothing

You wear a swimsuit to the pool. You wear a uniform to school. Language is the same.

Formal Mode (Principal):

'Good Morning.' 'Yes please.'

Casual Mode (Friends):

'Sup.' 'Yeah cool.'

MODULE 5: THE SCREEN

Digital Social Skills

Tool 11: The Tone Checker

The Rule: Short texts sound rude. Add a 'Softener'.

Blunt: 'Where are you.' (Angry)

Softened: 'Hey! Just wondering where you are? :)' (Friendly)

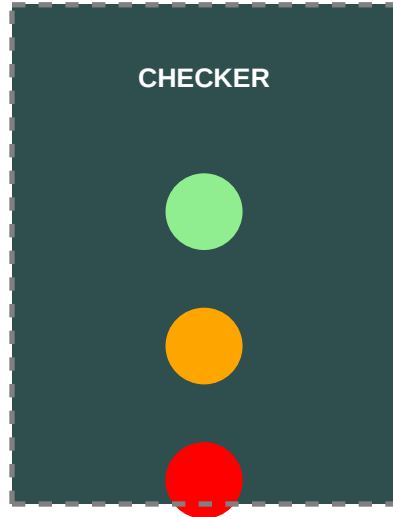
Tool 12: The Group Chat Survival Guide

Golden Rules for the Chat:

- 1. No Spamming:** Don't send 10 texts when 1 will do.
- 2. No Drama:** Never fight in public. Take it to DM.
- 3. The Exit Strategy:** It is okay to mute the chat if it's too loud.

THE NAVIGATOR'S PHYSICAL KIT

Instructions: Print on cardstock and cut along the dotted lines.



Integration: Your Social Roadmap

Social skills are a language. Your child is learning this as a second language. The goal is not to sound like everyone else. The goal is to be understood.